Revati M. Vaidya

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Tech policy and digital governance professional with 5+ years leading AI strategy, Digital Public Infrastructure, and large-scale data programs across India's public sector.

EDUCATION

Harvard University, John F. Kennedy School of Government — Cambridge, MA
Master in Public Administration — May 2027
Honors: Full tuition scholarship: John F. Kennedy Merit Fellowship and Sumner Feldberg Merit Fellowship; Inlaks Scholarship, 2025
Activities: Teaching Assistant, Prof. Jim Waldo (DPI664M: The Internet); Tech Policy Caucus
Relevant Coursework: Technology, Privacy & the Trans-national Nature of the Internet; Digital Governance in the Public Sector; Emerging Technology, Strategy, and Risk; Public Problem Solving with Generative AI: Challenges and Opportunities

Tata Institute of Social Sciences (TISS) — Mumbai, India
***Master of Arts in Development Studies (M.A, DS)* | Graduated Magna Cum Laude** — May 2020

Symbiosis International University — Pune, India
B.B.A Finance & International Business | *Honors:* **Awarded "Best Student"; Graduated in the top 5th percentile** — May 2017

EXPERIENCE

Ash Center for Democratic Governance and Innovation, Harvard Kennedy School — Cambridge, MA
Research Assistant - Informed Public Project (Public Information Ecosystems) — Jan 2026 – Present

- Developing an information inventory and analytical framework to map how citizens access, interpret, and act on information, assessing informational flows and quality dimensions across technology-driven environments

Precision Development (PxD) — New Delhi, India
Program Manager | Strategy & Partnerships Lead, MoA&FW, India — 2023 - 2025

- Founded and institutionalized the Ministry of Agriculture's Artificial Intelligence (AI) Cell, embedding AI-enabled solutions, ethical safeguards, & data governance standards for public-sector AI deployment for digital agriculture
- Directed strategy for a $2.2M Gates-funded PMU within the MoA, coordinating across donors, technologists, and states
- Led design and national scale-up of VISTAAR, a national Digital Public Infrastructure enabling interoperable public services, securing 6 state MoUs and extending digital advisory services to ~10M farmers
- Built cross-ministry partnerships, including co-developing an agriculture-domain LLM with the Ministry of Electronics & IT
- Positioned India's digital agriculture infrastructure within global Digital Public Infrastructure frameworks, enabling cross-country benchmarking and south-south partnerships (Kenya, OpenAgriNet)
- Deployed India's first WhatsApp-based climate information service, scaling hyperlocal weather forecasts to 50K+ coffee farmers

Senior Associate — 2022 - 2023

- Spearheaded policy transition of India's largest farmer-advisory service (Ama Krushi, 7M+ farmers) from donor to government ownership; authored Transition Toolkit adopted by donors and state governments to guide future handovers
- Directed a $150K women-focused digital extension project with SEWA Federation, designing governance models that established district-level centers serving 20K women farmers in the state of Gujarat
- Designed product roadmap for integrating WhatsApp/SMS into core farmer advisory services, tripling active monthly users to 3M

Associate — 2020 - 2022

- Created standardized engagement protocols that became the foundation of PxD's organizational data governance policy
- Executed A/B tests with 50K farmers to improve service engagement, generating recommendations that boosted uptake by 12%

Rebright Partners VC — Bangalore, India
Research Intern — 2017 - 2018

- Analyzed Indian consumer and tech sectors to support early-stage investment due diligence and pipeline coordination

PUBLICATIONS & POLICY OUTPUTS

- Compendium on Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Digital Agriculture, MoA&FW, 2024
- VISTAAR Bluebook: Digital Public Infrastructure for Agriculture, MoA&FW, 2024
- Transition Insights Report for Public-Private Service Transfers, PxD, 2023

Skills: Python, R, PostgreSQL, Stata, Excel, LaTeX, Open Data Kit, SurveyCTO

Languages: English, Marathi, Hindi, French (CIEP DELF A1 certified